

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff in G major (one sharp). The time signature is irregular, changing between 2/2, 3/2, and 2/2. The lyrics are written below the staff. Chord diagrams are placed above the staff at various points, indicating the harmonic structure. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star-ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis-ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis-ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

Chord diagrams: G (1 3 2), D (1 2 3), G (1 3 2), D (1 2 3), C (3), G (1 3 2), D (1 2 3), G (1 3 2), C (3), G (1 3 2), D (1 2 3), G (1 3 2), C (3), G (1 3 2).

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...